Podocarpus lawrencei 'Blue Gem'

Blue Gem Podocarpus, Blue Mountain Plum-pine

Family: Podocarpaceae



HABIT



OTHER



LEAF



OTHER

QUICK FACTS

Plant Type: Small tree or large shrub

Evergreen or deciduous
Evergreen

Growth & Size
Rate: Not stated
Size: Dwarf spreading or mounding conifer. Typically 2–4 ft tall and 3–10 ft wide in 10 years; some reports to 4 ft × 8–12 ft at maturity. Slow to (~15 cm/year). Female clone. [Oregon State University Landscape Plants; RHS; American Conifer Society; Great Plant Picks]

Sun

Water

Soil
Prefers well-drained or sandy soil; drought tolerant once established. Tolerates a range of soils including chalk, clay, loam, sand; pH acid to alkaline. [Oregon State University; RHS; Great Plant Picks; Shoot]

Zone 8a
Hardy to USDA Zone 7 (to ~0°F / −18°C in some reports); commonly listed Zone 7–9. Suitable for Atlanta Zone 8a. Best color in full sun; shelter from cold drying winds recommended. [American Conifer Society; Great Plant Picks; Iseli Nursery; RHS H5]

ORIGIN AND CHARACTERISTICS

Origin
Selection of Podocarpus lawrencei (syn. P. alpina), native to southwest Australia and Tasmania (sub-alpine regions). Cultivar raised in Tasmania prior to 1983 or selected in UK/Australia trade. [Oregon State University; Trees and Shrubs Online; American Conifer Society]

Form
Evergreen. Short flat blue-green needles; new growth in spring pink, red, or creamy with purple tinge, maturing blue-green. Spreading, arching branches with nodding tips. Can be sheared for low hedge. No significant fall color change. [Oregon State University; Trees and Shrubs Online; Great Plant Picks]. One of the hardier Podocarpus. Excellent blue foliage form. Female clone; fruit only if pollinated. Invasive status: not stated (introduced ornamental). [Oregon State University; Great Plant Picks]

Foliage
Not stated

Flowers and fruit
Not stated

Bark
Not stated

PLANTING NOTES

Establishment

Plant in full sun to light shade in well-drained soil. Drought tolerant once established. Tolerates pruning and shearing well for low hedge or ground cover. Suitable for rock gardens, front of border, containers (with care).
[Great Plant Picks; Ashwood Nurseries; RHS]

HEALTH

Health

Generally pest and disease free. Resistant to aphids, slugs, snails reported. No serious problems stated for this cultivar.
[Great Plant Picks; Burncoose]

Symptoms

None stated